

Gestational Diabetes - NIDDK

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Gestational Diabetes - NIDDK Home Health Information Diabetes Diabetes Overview What Is Diabetes? Gestational Diabetes English English Español Related Topics Gestational Diabetes View or Print All Sections Definition & Facts Gestational diabetes is a type of diabetes that occurs only during pregnancy. Gestational diabetes can cause health problems in both mother and baby. Managing your diabetes can help protect you and your baby. Symptoms & Causes Gestational diabetes often has no symptoms, or they may be mild, such as being thirstier than normal or having to urinate more often. Gestational diabetes is sometimes related to the hormonal changes of pregnancy that make your body less able to use insulin. Genes and extra weight may also play a role. Tests & Diagnosis Your doctor will test you for gestational diabetes between 24 and 28 weeks of pregnancy. Tests include the glucose challenge test and the oral glucose tolerance test (OGTT). If the results of the glucose challenge test show high blood glucose, you will return for an OGTT test to confirm the diagnosis of gestational diabetes. Management & Treatment Managing gestational diabetes includes following a healthy eating plan and being physically active. If your eating plan and physical activity aren't enough to keep your blood glucose in your target range, you may need insulin. Prevention You can lower your chance of getting gestational diabetes by losing ext